Nicole Meenan

Salford, Greater Manchester | 07522 427545 | n.meenan@sky.com

https://nicolemeenan.github.io/nicole-meenan-portfolio/ | linkedin.com/in/nicole-meenan-a23371371

Creative Gameplay, Level and Mechanic Designer with a 2:1 from Abertay University in Game Design and Production. Nominated for the TIGA Graduate of the Year Award for Production and Enterprise. Experience working in teams and delivering interactive projects to well-respected clients like Rockstar Games. Adept at managing sprint schedules, bridging technical and creative pipelines, and having experience across all disciplines.

A year from graduation, I am currently focused on expanding my portfolio by developing an independent game project while continuing to build my knowledge by following industry journalism, local events, and professional networking opportunities.

EDUCATION

Abertay University | *BA (Hons) Game Design and Production (2:1) - Sep 2021 - Jul 2025*

- Specialized in interactive workflows, agile production, user engagement, aesthetics, and engine pipelines using a range of technical softwares within teams of people and solo projects.

CORE SKILLS

- **Management:** Agile/Scrum, Team Leadership, Milestone Tracking, Resource Allocation, Jira and Github.
- **Design & Tech:** C#, Unity, Unreal Engine (Blueprints), Level Design, UX/UI Design.
- **Creative Content:** 2D Art & Animation (Aseprite), Marketing, Audio Design.

PROJECT HIGHLIGHTS

***Ophelia* - Honors Project | Solo Developer**

Unity • C# • 2D/Pixel Art • Narrative • Audio

Independently designed and developed a complete game from concept to final production, combining C#, 2D art, narrative, audio, game design, focusing on bridging the gap between my creative and technical skills. The project explores societal expectations placed on women through the antagonist's surreal psychological-horror dreams;

using player discomfort and uncertainty as deliberate design tools. My stand-out project management got me nominated for the **TIGA Graduate of the Year Award – Production & Enterprise.**

3 Game Jams | Game Designer & Programmer

Design • Programming • 2D Art • Balancing

Collaborated across three fast-paced game jams, contributing to game design, programming, gameplay balancing and 2D UI art. Adapted quickly to tight production deadlines while working with teammates to develop and refine playable concepts. For *Get Down to Groove*, I took sole responsibility for programming and helped the team achieve a **Top 3 placement at university**.

Black Mass | Professional Project for Rockstar Games

3D Artist • Animator • Puzzle Designer • Marketing

Collaborated within a multidisciplinary team to develop a first-person psychological horror game for client **Rockstar Games**. Designed and implemented environmental puzzles, including padlock and light-switch based puzzles, alongside gameplay scares, jumpscare animations and 3D environmental filler assets. Created the game's **gameplay trailer**, showcasing the project and its core mechanics. Contributed to the player's progression, exploration and tension. Was recognised for stand out work on the gameplay trailer, showing I understood the game and genre.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Spice&Grind, Manchester - Solo Trailer Manager & Operator | *May 2026 - Present*

- Sole manager of operations for an independent coffee trailer, working Monday to Friday under zero supervision.
- Daily inventory tracking and stock forecasting.
- Maintain workplace upkeep, workflow efficiency, customer satisfaction, health and safety compliance, serving as the sole face of the business.

Blue Palm Coffee, Manchester - Barista & Shift Operator | *Jan 2026 - Jun 2026*

- Independently manage daily operations of a luxury outdoor trailer, maintaining strict quality control.
- Own inventory tracking, stock control, and supplier tracking to guarantee zero service downtime.

Salt and Pine, St Andrews - Team Leader & Shack Manager | *Apr - Aug 2025 & Dec 2025 - Jan 2026*

- Led a frontline service team of three, managing task delegation during peak periods.
- Trusted with complete operational oversight of an isolated location, managing logistics and upkeep.

Invercarse Hotel, Dundee - Senior Events Staff & Trainer | *Jul 2022 - Feb 2024*

- Spearheaded top-table service execution at large corporate functions and weddings.
- Trained and mentored incoming staff, designing onboarding workflows to maintain quality standards.